

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Middle School | Unit 9

Suffixes -able & -ible



Today I am learning that the suffixes -able and -ible often form adjectives meaning able to be or capable of.

1 Learn the Meaning

The suffixes -able and -ible often form adjectives. They can show that something can be done or has a particular possibility. The endings sound similar, so use base words and word families to help with spelling.

readable
able to be read

visible
able to be seen

washable
able to be washed

reversible
able to be reversed

2 Build the Word

Use the base or related word and suffix to build the adjective. Then explain what the new word means.

Base / related	Suffix	New word	What it means
read	-able		
predict	-able		
comfort	-able		
access	-ible		
reverse	-ible		

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

For a design challenge, our group had to create a portable reading stand that could be used in different places. The first model was light and adjustable, but its instructions were not very readable. We rewrote them so each step was clear and predictable. The stand also needed a washable cover because it might be used outdoors. When we tested the hinge, we discovered that the frame was reversible, so the stand could face either direction. A bright marker made the page numbers more visible, while a flexible strip helped hold thick books open. We checked that every control was accessible to someone using the stand from a seated position. By the final trial, the design was comfortable to use and the setup was easy to repeat. Our teacher asked whether every change was possible to explain using the evidence we had collected. We realised that many useful describing words ended in -able or -ible. Some had an obvious base word, while others were easier to understand by comparing related words and their meanings. Before packing it away, we checked whether the stand was durable, the labels were legible, and each broken part would be replaceable.



Highlight the -able and -ible adjectives. Underline the base or related word when you can identify one.

4 Word Detective

Choose one -able or -ible adjective from the passage and investigate its structure and meaning.

- Write an -able or -ible word from the passage.

- What base or related word can you identify?

- What does the adjective mean in this context?

- How does the suffix help you understand the word?

5 Sort the Words

Sort the adjectives by their ending.

readable washable predictable comfortable

visible flexible reversible accessible

Ends in -able

Ends in -ible

6 Use It in Writing



Complete the sentence starters.

- A flexible material can _____

- Use an -able or -ible adjective in your own sentence.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises the suffixes -able / -ible
- ☐ Finds a base or related word
- ☐ Explains how the suffix affects meaning
- ☐ Spells and uses derived adjectives



Capture idea:

Find an -able or -ible adjective in a book or information text. Record a base or related word and explain what the adjective means.